Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Cary Crates

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist

Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with **Chip Patina**.
- Has developed mutual respect with **Frank Lloyd Wrong** despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- **Al Baster** likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Cary Crates. I move priceless objects for a living. Please do not test that sentence by handing me your drink.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Cary Crates

Behind the portrait

Your stake tonight

A childhood memory of being fired on the spot makes one damaged delivery feel like losing an entire life of competence.

During the investigation

Keep your account private until each round. Your printed answers establish what happened. You can react in your own style, but do not invent a new event, witness, or alibi.

Conversations to start

- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page.
- Keep your private branch readings for their announced rounds.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Cary Crates

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A chair made of metal is sitting on information.*

2 *A cabinet for household supplies has accepted a mysterious new donation.*

3 *The highest point of the vehicle entrance conceals some information.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I cracked a frame corner on delivery. Wrote old damage. Grant had the photographs and offered to keep them from my employer if I signed what he wanted. I lost a job once with my coat still on the peg. Haven't forgotten the feeling. I move very expensive things now. Still felt like the same kid when he mentioned making the call.

IF MURDERER

I cracked a frame corner on delivery. Wrote old damage. Grant had the photographs. He could send them to my employer or have me sign without another check. I lost a job once with my coat still on the peg. Haven't forgotten it. He knew that call could finish my work here. He enjoyed letting me decide which signature would postpone it.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Took the shop gifts to service. Wrapped crest glass was in the carton; the manager signed. Then the freight lift stuck with the empty packing frames inside. Al's crew wanted paying before another move. I left the damage report open and corrected the corner entry. Great night for deliveries. If anybody needs a chair moved, ask. I'm better when there's a job.

IF MURDERER

Took the shop gifts to service. Freight lift stuck. Al's crew wanted their balance. I corrected the frame-corner report. Grant still had the first version, so I went to his private place to get it back. Glass set out. Nobody home. I waited, picked up the shop carton to clear the chair, then left. Great night for deliveries. If you need a chair moved, ask. I'd rather do that than stand here answering for the word old.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Crest glass in the signed carton. The manager received it before setting the place. Grant drank from that engraving. The frame photographs show when I cracked the corner; I've signed the revised report. It was my damage. There. A sentence I could have used the first time. Would have saved a lot of standing around hoping nobody opened a file.

IF MURDERER

The engraved gift stayed boxed. Service set a plain spare and served Grant his drink in that. Receiving the carton didn't mean unpacking it. The frame crack was mine. I've corrected that report. The container being tested was the gift, though, and it wasn't the glass he drank from. A signed delivery slip doesn't finish a service job.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill him. The crest glass went to the manager and appears in the toast photograph. The other frame was intact before my delivery and cracked afterward. I've signed the repair charge. I don't know if I still have the job. Chip can give them my number. I'll answer. Would rather get the call than keep waiting for Grant to decide when to make it.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The engraved glass was unpacked and used. Its crest appears in the service photograph; the manager's receipt accounts for the carton. I stole poison during the preview and later put it in that waiting glass. I called it a spare to disconnect the investigated container from the drink he consumed. Grant could expose my false damage report and force another unsafe signature out of me. I was afraid of losing the job. Nobody's going to ask me to move anything now. That is the smallest part of what I've lost.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.